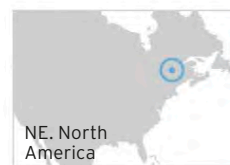


# Château Frontenac

*A château-style Canadian hotel built in an age when railway travel was the height of luxury*



As the railway network expanded across Canada, the rail companies developed a series of grand hotels to serve their passengers in style. Almost all of them were châteaulike in design, with towers, turrets, and other Scottish baronial and French château elements. Of these grand hotels, the most famous is Château Frontenac in Québec City, built by the Canadian Pacific Railway. This imposing building stands at the eastern edge of Old Québec's Upper Town high on a hill above the St. Lawrence River.

## A French-Gothic extravaganza

Château Frontenac was designed by Bruce Price (1845–1903), one of the main architects employed by the Canadian Pacific Railway to design their hotels. Built in

1892–1893, the hotel is modeled on the châteaux found in the Loire Valley in France but with additional Gothic and high Victorian elements. Presenting an asymmetrical profile to the city beneath, its most commanding features are its steeply pitched roofs, massive towers and turrets, and tall chimneys. The hotel stands on a gray stone ashlar base and is faced with Glenboig fireclay bricks made in Lanarkshire, Scotland. Its interior is a wealth of marble staircases, mahogany panels, wrought iron, and carved stone. The hotel has 611 guest rooms and numerous reception rooms, bars, and other facilities. On its roof are four beehives, their 70,000 bees producing around 650lb (295kg) of honey a year. Among the hotel's executive suites are the Trudeau-Trudeau Suite, named after the father and son Canadian prime ministers.

## THE HORSESHOE

Château Frontenac is basically horseshoe-shaped with four wings of uneven length. Initially meant to be a square building, the construction of the Terrasse Dufferin, which wraps around the eastern side of the hotel, resulted in a more complex structure.

